Foam rolling — lower body (hEDS / HSD safe)

Soft-tissue rolling for tightness (R7) · after training or on rest days, never before a session · pick by target

Target area

Glutes / hip · Quads · Hamstrings / adductors · Calves / shins

⚠ What rolling does — and what it can't

Rolling eases the feeling of tightness, mostly through your nervous system: pain and tension settle for a while. It doesn't 'release' fascia, and harder pressure adds nothing. Light pressure, muscle only — EDS tissue needs care. Tightness is what rolling is for; range is not (R7).

AREAS — pick by what you trained (30–60 s an area · ~5–8 min a sitting)

Muscle only · light pressure, about 3–4/10 · slow passes, 2–4 s each way · seated: fists, elbows soft

Hips and thighs

1 **Glutes (seated on the roller)** — 30–60 s per side, foam roller
Glute max · glute med
Hands behind you on fists, elbows soft (R2); lean onto one side
Ankle over the other knee only if the hip stays comfortable (R1); stay off the sitting bone

2 **Hamstrings (seated on the roller)** — 30–60 s per side, foam roller
Biceps femoris · semimembranosus · semitendinosus
Hands behind you on fists, elbows soft (R2); turn the foot in, then out
Stay well above the back of the knee — never roll over the knee

3 **Quads (face down on your forearms)** — 30–60 s per side, foam roller
Vastus lateralis · vastus medialis · rectus femoris
Trunk braced, no sag in the low back (R3); turn the leg in, then out
Stop well above the kneecap — never roll over it

4 **Adductors (face down on your forearms)** — 30–60 s per side, foam roller
Adductor longus · magnus · brevis
One knee out to the side, only to ~70–80% of your range (R1)
Roller along the inner thigh, mid-muscle; stop short of the groin and the knee

5 **Side of the hip (ball against the wall)** — 20–40 s per side, tennis ball, wall
Tensor fasciae latae · front of glute med
Ball just below the front of the hip bone; small circles, gentle lean
Very light; stay on the small muscle, off the hip bone

Lower legs

6 **Calves (seated, roller under the calves)** — 30–60 s per side, foam roller
Gastrocnemius · soleus
Hands behind you on fists, elbows soft (R2); turn the foot in, then out
Stay off the Achilles tendon and the back of the knee

7 **Shins (ball pressed by hand, seated)** — 20–40 s per side, tennis ball
Tibialis anterior — the muscle beside the shin bone
Seated, knee bent; press the ball into the muscle by hand, small circles
Never on the shin bone itself; light pressure

Every area, every time — hEDS / HSD rules

- Muscle only — never on a joint, tendon, bony point, the kneecap or the back of the knee
- Light pressure: about 3–4/10, never sharp — harder adds nothing; lacrosse ball: same limit, lean in less
- Slow passes, 2–4 s each way; pause up to 20–30 s on a tender spot; 30–60 s an area
- Hands holding you up: on fists, elbows soft (R2); trunk braced when face down (R3)
- Positions stay short of end range: ankle over knee or knee out only as far as comfortable (R1)
- Tingling, numbness, or a joint that feels looser → stop and move off; leave that area out next time (§2.6)

Target index — pick areas by what you trained

Glutes	1
Glute med / side of the hip	1 · 5
Hamstrings	2
Quads	3
Adductors	4
Calves	6
Shins (tibialis)	7
Knee · Achilles · groin	never rolled

When and how long

After training (later that day) or on rest days — never before a session (it adds range that fades)
Pick 3–5 areas by what you trained · ~5–8 min a sitting · kit: foam roller + tennis ball (or lacrosse ball)

v5 — the lacrosse ball as an option: same 3–4/10 limit, lean in less (Stage 0 §1.3 · D-93)